

several endemic species, including the critically endangered Ethiopian wolf and mountain nyala.

Lake Bogoria

Location Western Kenya, in the East African Rift Valley

This shallow, very saline lake lies in a section of the down-faulted East African Rift Valley between the Maji Moto block to the west and the Bogoria Escarpment to the east. The water depth ranges from 36 to 46 ft (11 to 14m), with the deepest area being the south basin, a relict volcanic crater. Many hot springs and geysers in and around the lake testify to

continued geothermal activity. At times, 1.5 million flamingos feed in the alkaline waters.

The Great Dike

Location Running south-north from east of Bulawayo to just south of the Mozambique border, Zimbabwe

Despite its name, this feature is not a dike but a loppolith, a mass of intruded igneous rocks that is more or less saucer-shaped in cross-section, fed by a vertical dike beneath. Its surface manifestation is a series of narrow ridges, running 340 miles (550km) from south to north. It was injected into the surrounding rocks about

2.5 billion years ago and is rich in minerals including gold, silver, chromium, platinum, and nickel.

Piton de la Fournaise

Location Réunion Island, in the Indian Ocean, off the east coast of Madagascar

In English, Piton de la Fournaise translates as “Furnace Peak.” This is one of the biggest and most active volcanoes in the world, with more than 150 eruptions recorded since the 17th century, the most recent being in 2017. More than 530,000 years old, this shield volcano grew over the Réunion

hotspot, which is thought to have been active for 66 million years. For most of its history, its lava flows have intermingled with those of Piton des Neiges. There are many craters within the caldera, which is 5 miles (8km) across. The volcano’s activity is closely monitored at an observatory on its slopes.

Other mountains and volcanoes in Africa

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